

Chapter 1



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Published by Kehot Publication Society

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כי קרוב אליך
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Chapter 1

פרק א

We have learned (*Niddah*, end of ch. 3):¹ “An oath is administered to him:

תִּנָּא [בְּסוּף פֶּרֶק ג' דְּנִידָה]: “מִשְׁבִּיעִים אוֹתוֹ,

Before a Jew is born, an oath is administered to him in heaven, charging him:

‘Be righteous and be not wicked; and even if the whole world judging you by your actions tells you that you are righteous, regard yourself as wicked.’”

תְּהִי צַדִּיק וְאַל תְּהִי רָשָׁע. וְאִפִּילוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָם בּוֹלֵוּ אוֹמְרִים לְךָ צַדִּיק אַתָּה – הִיָּה בְּעֵינֶיךָ כְּרָשָׁע.”

The soul of a Jew descends into a body for a purpose—in order to fulfill a specific spiritual mission in this world. To enable him to fulfill it, a heavenly oath is administered to him that he “be righteous and not wicked” and concurrently that he regard himself as wicked and not righteous. The root (שבע) of the verb מִשְׁבִּיעִים (“an oath is administered”) is virtually identical with the root (שבע) of the verb מִשְׁבִּיעִים (“one causes [him] to be sated”). Accordingly, the oath charging him to be righteous may also be understood to mean that the soul is thereby invested (“sated”) with the power that enables it to fulfill its destiny in life on earth.

This calls for explanation, for we have learned in the *Mishnah* (*Avot*, ch. 2),² “Be not wicked in your own estimation.”

וְצָרִיד לְהִבְיז, דְּהָא תִּנָּא [אַבוֹת פֶּרֶק ב']: “וְאַל תְּהִי רָשָׁע בְּפִנֵּי עַצְמְךָ.”

How, then, can we say that an oath is administered to the soul that it regard itself as wicked when this directly contradicts the Mishnaic injunction not to regard oneself as wicked?³

Furthermore, if a person considers himself wicked, he will be **grieved at heart and depressed**, וגם, אם יהיה בעיניו כרשע – ירע לִבּוֹ וְיִהְיֶה עֵצִב,

and consequently will not be able to serve G-d joyfully and with a **contented heart**, ולא יוכל לַעֲבֹד ה' בְּשִׂמְחָה וּבְטוֹב לֵבָב,

Apart from the previously mentioned contradiction from the Mishnah, an additional question is now raised. A cardinal principle in the service of G-d is that it be performed with joy—joy at the privilege of serving Him either through performing a positive command or by refraining from that which is prohibited. How then can one be required to take an oath to consider himself wicked, when this will cause him to be depressed, making it impossible for him to serve G-d with joy?

Furthermore, just as the first part of the oath, “Be righteous and be not wicked,” is vital to his success in realizing his life’s mission, so, too, the fulfillment of the second part of the oath, that he consider himself wicked, is imperative. How can this possibly be so, when such an attitude hinders his joyful service of G-d?

while if his heart will not be at all grieved by this self-appraisal, ואם לא ירע לִבּוֹ כָּלֵל מִזֶּה,

I.e., if we should propose that in order to fulfill the oath, the person will indeed regard himself as wicked but at the same time will resolve that his wickedness shall not perturb him so as not to encumber his joyful service of G-d,

he may be led to irreverence, G-d forbid, by such an attitude, with **sin perturbing him not at all**. יָכוֹל לָבוֹא לִידֵי קְלוּת, חַס וְשָׁלוֹם.

For although his original resolve that being wicked will not perturb him stems only from his sincere desire to serve G-d with joy, yet such a resolution may very well lead to a situation where wickedness will truly not disturb him.

However, the [above] matter will be more clearly understood after a preliminary discussion of the true meaning of “righteous” and “wicked.” אֵדָה הָעֲנָנ,

כִּי הִנֵּה מְצִינוּ בַּגְּמָרָא ה' חֲלוּקוֹת: צַדִּיק וְטוֹב לוֹ,
צַדִּיק וְרָע לוֹ,

We find in the Gemara five distinct types: a righteous man who prospers, materially as well as spiritually—he knows only good; a righteous man who suffers, in both a material as well as spiritual sense: spiritually, he has not yet vanquished all his evil, and in the material sense, too, he is wanting;

רָשָׁע וְטוֹב לוֹ, רָשָׁע וְרָע לוֹ, וּבִינֹנִי.

a wicked man in whom there is some good and who prospers; a wicked man who suffers spiritually and materially; and an intermediate man—the beinoni.

וּפִירְשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא: "צַדִּיק וְטוֹב לוֹ – צַדִּיק גָּמור,

The Gemara explains:⁴ “the righteous man who prospers” is the consummate lit., “complete” tzaddik;

Once he has achieved this level, physical suffering—to cleanse the soul from the impurities of sin—is unnecessary; he therefore prospers materially as well.

צַדִּיק וְרָע לוֹ – צַדִּיק שְׂאִינוּ גָּמור."

the “righteous man who suffers” is the imperfect lit., “incomplete” tzaddik.

He therefore experiences some measure of material suffering, thereby cleansing the soul while it is yet clothed in the body, so that he will not have to endure any spiritual suffering in the World to Come.

Accordingly, the Gemara is not referring to two tzaddikim on the same spiritual level, one of whom prospers while the other suffers; rather, it speaks of two distinct levels of tzaddikim. The Gemara thus cites only two characterizations regarding the tzaddik—“consummate” and “imperfect” (lit., “complete” and “incomplete”). The terms “who prospers” or “who suffers” do not indicate his spiritual level: they merely describe his resultant material status.

וּבִרְעִיא מְהִימְנָא פְּרִשְׁתַּ מְשֻׁפְּטִים פִּירְשׁ: צַדִּיק וְרָע
לוֹ – שְׁהָרַע שָׁבוּ כְּפוּף לְטוֹב וְכו',

In *Raaya Mehemna* (*Parashat Mishpatim*),⁵ it is explained that “the righteous man who suffers” is one whose evil nature is subservient to his good nature.⁶

He is a tzaddik who still retains some vestige of evil, albeit subservient to his good nature. Accordingly, a “righteous man who prospers” is a tzaddik in whom there is only good, since he has totally transformed his evil nature.

According to the Zohar (of which *Raaya Mehemna* is a part), the terms “who prospers” and “who suffers” also indicate and describe the level of the tzaddik. The “tzaddik who prospers” is a tzaddik in whom there is only good—the evil within him having already been transformed to good; the “tzaddik who suffers” is a tzaddik of lower stature—one who still harbors some evil.

However, we must now understand why redundant titles are given to each level of tzaddik: “complete tzaddik” and “tzaddik who prospers”; “incomplete tzaddik” and “tzaddik who suffers.” If the “complete tzaddik” is the

“tzaddik who prospers” (i.e., in whom there is only good) and the “incomplete tzaddik” is the “tzaddik who suffers” (i.e., retains a vestige of evil), why then is it necessary to give each tzaddik two appellations?

The explanation provided further (in ch. 10) is that each descriptive term denotes a specific aspect of the divine service of the tzaddik. The terms “complete tzaddik” and “incomplete tzaddik” denote the level of service of the tzaddik’s G-dly soul, i.e., the tzaddik’s love of G-d, for it is by virtue of this love that he is called “tzaddik.” The “complete tzaddik” is he who has attained perfection in his love of G-d in a manner of *ahavah betaanugim* (“love of delights”)—the serene love of fulfillment. The tzaddik whose *ahavah betaanugim* is as yet imperfect is called the “incomplete (or unperfected) tzaddik.”

The terms “tzaddik who prospers” and “tzaddik who suffers” denote the tzaddik’s status vis-à-vis his efforts in transforming his animal soul to holiness. For the tzaddik, through his lofty service of *ahavah betaanugim*, transforms the evil within him into holiness and good. The designation “tzaddik who prospers” indicates that he has already totally transformed the evil within him and now good alone remains, while the “tzaddik who suffers” is one who has not yet managed to totally transform the evil within him to good; a vestige of it still remains.

The explanations that follow make it abundantly clear that the evil referred to here is no more than an amorphous evil still harbored in the heart of the “incomplete tzaddik.” For the tzaddik has no association with actual evil that manifests itself in thought or speech and most certainly not with the evil that finds expression in actions.

In the Gemara (end of ch. 9 of *Berachot*),⁷ [it is stated] that the righteous are “judged” i.e., motivated and ruled by their good nature, their good nature having the final say; the wicked are judged i.e., motivated and ruled by their evil nature, their evil nature having the final say;

ובגמרא סוף פרק ט' דברכות: "צדיקים – יצר טוב שופטן בו", רשעים – יצר הרע שופטן,

intermediate men are “judged” by both the good and evil nature.⁸

בינונים – זה וזה שופטן ובו'.

Rabbah declared: “I, for example, am a *beinoni*.” Said Abbaye to him, “Master, you make it impossible for any creature to live....”

אמר רבה: כגון אנא בינוני. אמר ליה אביי: לא שביק מר חיי ללך בריה וכו'."

Abbaye argued thus: “If you are a *beinoni*, then all those on a lower level than you fall into the category of the wicked, concerning whom our Sages say:⁹ ‘The wicked, even while alive, are considered dead.’ By calling yourself a *beinoni*, you thus make it impossible for anyone to live.”

To understand all the aforesaid clearly [an explanation is called for].

ולזהבין כל זה באר היטב,

In addition to the question which will soon follow—that according to the common conception of a *beinoni* as a person having half *mitzvot* and half transgressions, how could a great sage like Rabbah mistake himself for

a *beinoni*—a further question is implied:

If a *beinoni* is simply one having half *mitzvot* and half transgressions, then his status is readily identifiable, and there is no possible room for debate.

And also to understand the statement of Job (*Bava Batra*, ch. 1)¹⁰:
“L-rd of the universe! You have created righteous men, You have created wicked men...,”

וגם להבין מה שאמר איוב [בבא בתרא פרק א':]
"רבונו של עולם, בראת צדיקים בראת רשעים
בו",

for He does not decree [which persons are to be] righteous and wicked.

והא 'צדיק' ו'רשע' לא קאמר!

The Gemara¹¹ relates that G-d decrees that a child about to be born will be wise or foolish, strong or weak, and so on. However, whether the child will be righteous or wicked, G-d does not say: this is not predetermined; rather, it is left to the individual's free choice.

How, then, are we to understand Job's plaint, "You have *created* righteous men, You have *created* wicked men"?¹²

We must also understand the essential nature (*mahut*) of the rank of the *beinoni*.

וגם להבין מהות מדרגת הבינוני,

The *mahut* of a *tzaddik* is righteousness; the *mahut* of the wicked man is evil. What is the *mahut*—the essential nature—of the *beinoni*?

He is certainly not one whose deeds are half virtuous and half sinful; for if this were so, how could Rabbah err in [classifying] himself as a *beinoni*,

שבדאי אינו מחצה זכיות ומחצה עונות, שאם כן,
איך טעה רבה בעצמו לומר שהוא בינוני,

when it is known that "his mouth never ceased studying [the Torah],"¹³ so much so that even the Angel of Death had no dominion over him.¹⁴

ונודע דלא פסיק פומיה מגירסא, עד שאפילו
מלאך המות לא היה יכול לשלוט בו,

Such was Rabbah's diligence that he did not neglect his studies for even one moment. Qualitatively, too, his learning was on so high a plane that the Angel of Death was unable to overpower him.

How, then, could he err in considering that half his deeds were sinful, G-d forbid?

ואיך היה יכול לטעות במחצה עונות חס ושלום?

Furthermore, when can a person be considered a *beinoni*? For at the time one sins until he repents he is deemed completely wicked,

(and if he was sinful and then repented, thus ceasing to be wicked, he is deemed completely righteous¹⁵).

Even he who violates a minor prohibition of the Rabbis is termed wicked, as is stated in Yevamot, ch. 2,¹⁶ and in Niddah, ch. 1.¹⁷

Moreover, even he who himself does not sin but has the opportunity to forewarn another against sinning and fails to do so is termed wicked (*Shevuot*, ch. 6¹⁸).

All the more so, he who neglects any positive law which he is able to fulfill,

for instance, whoever is able to study Torah and does not do so,

to whom our Sages¹⁹ have applied the verse, “Because he has despised the word of the L-rd (i.e., the Torah)...[that soul] shall be utterly cut off....”²⁰

It is thus plain that such a person is called wicked, more so than he who violates a prohibition of the Sages.

This being so, we must conclude that the *beinoni* is not guilty even of the sin of neglecting to study Torah.

A sin most difficult to avoid and counted among those sins that people transgress daily.²¹

This is why Rabbah mistook himself for a *beinoni*.

Since a *beinoni* is innocent even of neglecting Torah study, Rabbah could [mistakenly] consider himself a *beinoni*, even though he scrupulously observed even the most minor commandments and never ceased from his studies.

As for what is written in the Zohar III, p. 231: “He whose sins are few [is classed as a ‘righteous man who suffers’],”

ועוד, שהרי בשעה שעושה עונות נקרא רשע גמור

[ואם אחר-כך עשה תשובה – נקרא צדיק גמור],

ואפילו העובר על איסור קל של דברי סופרים – מקרי רשע, כדאיתא בפרק ב' דיבמות ובפרק קמא דנדה.

ואפילו מי שיש בידו למחות ולא מיחה נקרא רשע [בפרק ו' דשבועות].

וכל שכן וקל וחמר, במבטל איזו מצות עשה שאפשר לו למימנה,

כמו כל שאפשר לו לעסוק בתורה ואינו עוסק,

שעליו דרשו רבותינו זכרונם לברכה: "כי דבר ה' בזה וגו' הכרת תכרת וגו'".

ופשיטא דמקרי רשע טפי מעובר איסור דרבנן.

ואם כן, על כרחך הבינוני אין בו אפילו עון ביטול תורה,

ומשום הכי טעה רבה בעצמו לומר שהוא בינוני

ומה שכתוב בזהר חלק ג' דף רל"א: כל שממעטין עונותיו וכו',

implying that even according to the *Zohar*, the meaning of a “righteous man who suffers” is one who does have sins, albeit few; and if so, a *beinoni* must be one who is in part virtuous and in part sinful,

this is the query of Rav Hamnuna to Elijah.

היא שאלת רב המנונא לאליהו,

But according to Elijah’s answer [ibid.], the meaning of a “righteous man who suffers” is as stated in *Raaya Mehemna* on *Parashat Mishpatim*, quoted above i.e., that the “righteous man who suffers” is one whose evil nature is subservient to his good nature.

אבל לפי תשובת אליהו שם, הפירוש "צדיק ורע לו" הוא כמו שכתוב ברעיא מהימנא פרשה משפטים דלעיל.

And the Torah has seventy facets (modes of interpretation).²²

ושבעים פנים לתורה:

The Rebbe notes that the words, “And the Torah has seventy facets,” help us understand Rav Hamnuna’s query. It is difficult to understand how Rav Hamnuna would even entertain the notion that a “righteous man who suffers” is one who actually sins, inasmuch as all the abovementioned questions clearly lead us to assume the opposite. Rav Hamnuna’s query, however, was prompted only by the fact that “the Torah has seventy facets,” and he thought that this was possibly one of these facets.

As for the well-known saying²³ that one [whose deeds and misdeeds are] equally balanced is called a *beinoni*, while [he who has] a majority of virtues outweighing his sins is called a *tzaddik*,

והא דאמרינן בעלמא, דמחצה על מחצה מקרי בינוני, ורוב זכיות מקרי צדיק,

this is only a borrowed name, i.e., a figurative use of the term borrowed from its true usage in order to emphasize a particular point. Thus the names *beinoni* and *tzaddik*, denoting a balance between merits and sins, are in fact but borrowed names

הוא שם המושאל

used in regard to reward and punishment,

לענין שכר ועונש,

because one is judged according to the majority [of his deeds],

לפי שגדון אחר רובו,

and he is termed “righteous” in reference to his verdict, since he is acquitted at his trial.

ומקרי צדיק בדינו מאחר שזוכה בדין,

It is only in this legal sense that the term *tzaddik* is applied to one who performs more good deeds than evil.

If, however, we seek to truly define the distinct qualities and ranks of *tzaddikim* and *beinonim*,

אָבֿל לֵעֲנֵן אָמִיתֵת שֵׁם הַתּוֹאֵר וְהַמַּעֲלָה שֶׁל מַעֲלֵת
וּמִדְּרָגוֹת תְּלִיקוֹת צַדִּיקִים וּבֵינוֹנִים,

our Sages have remarked that the righteous are “judged” i.e., motivated and ruled, solely by their good nature, as it is written, “And my heart is a void within me,”²⁴

אָמְרוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ-זְכוֹנָם-לְבָרְכָהּ: "צַדִּיקִים יֵצֵר טוֹב
שׁוֹפֵטָן, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְלִבִּי חֲלָל בְּקִרְבִּי"

meaning that he i.e., David, the author of this verse was devoid of an evil nature, having slain it through fasting.

– שֶׁאֵין לוֹ יֵצֵר הָרַע, כִּי הִרְגוּ בְּתַעֲנִית;

David extirpated his evil nature through fasting; other ways, too, are possible.

We thus see from the Gemara that the definition of *tzaddik* in its true sense applies to the person who has rid himself of his evil nature.

But whoever has not attained this degree of ridding himself of his evil nature, even though his virtues outnumber his sins, is not at all at the level and rank of *tzaddik*.

אָבֿל כָּל מִי שֶׁלֹּא הִגִּיעַ לְמִדְּרָגָה זוֹ, אַף שֶׁזְכוּיָתוֹ
מְרֻבֵּים עַל עֲוֹנוֹתָיו – אֵינוֹ בְּמַעֲלַת וּמִדְּרַגַּת צַדִּיק
כָּלֵל.

In fact, not only has he not reached the rank of *tzaddik*, he has not yet attained even the level of *beinoni*, as has been demonstrated above.

This is why our Sages have expounded:²⁵ “The Almighty saw that the righteous were few, so He arose and planted i.e., and spread them in every generation,”

וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ-זְכוֹנָם-לְבָרְכָהּ בְּמִדְּרָשׁ: "רָאָה
הַקְּדוֹשׁ-בְּרוּךְ-הוּא בְּצַדִּיקִים שֶׁהֵם מוּעָטִים – עָמַד
וַשְׁתַּלֵּן בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר וְכוּ',

[for,] as it is written, “The *tzaddik* is the foundation of the world.”²⁶

וַיִּכְמוּ שֶׁכְּתוּב: וְצַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם:"

Thus, in each generation, there must be a *tzaddik* who serves as the “foundation of the world.”

This paucity of *tzaddikim* (“the righteous were few”) can be explained only if a *tzaddik* is he who has totally rid himself of his evil nature. Were the term *tzaddik* to mean one whose good deeds outweigh the evil, why then do our Sages say that “the righteous were few” when the overwhelming majority of Jews have more good deeds than evil!

However, the explanation of the matter, so that we better understand the levels of *tzaddik* and *beinoni*, as well as the various gradations within their ranks,

אֵךְ בִּיאֹר הָעֲנִיָּו,

[is to be found] in light of what Rabbi Chaim Vital wrote in *Shaar Hakedushah* (and in *Etz Chaim*, Portal 50, ch. 2)—

עַל פִּי מֶה שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַב חַיִּים וִיטָאֵל זְכוֹנּוֹ לְבָרְכָהּ
בְּשַׁעַר הַקְּדוּשָׁה [וּבְעֵץ חַיִּים שֶׁעַר ג' פָּרָק ב'],

that every Jew, whether righteous or wicked, possesses two souls, דלכל איש ישראל, אחד צדיק ואחד רשע, יש שתי נשמות,

as it is written, “And *neshamot* (souls) which I have made.”²⁷ ונשמות אני עשיתי,

Though the verse speaks of an individual Jew (as is indicated by the singular form of the word *ruach* (spirit) in the preceding phrase, “When the spirit of a *man* which emanates from Me will be humbled...”), the plural term souls is nevertheless used, indicating that *every* Jew possesses two souls.

These are two *nefashot*²⁸—two souls and life-forces. שהן שתי נפשות

One soul originates in the *kelipah* and *sitra achara*. נפש אחת מצד הקליפה וסטרא אחרא,

“*Kelipah*” means a shell or peel. G-d created forces which conceal the G-dly life-force found in all creation, as a peel covers and conceals a fruit. “*Sitra achara*” means “the other side”—the side of creation that is the antithesis of holiness and purity. (The two terms are generally synonymous.)

It is this *nefesh* (which originates in the *kelipah* and *sitra achara*) והיא המתלבשת בדם האדם להחיות הגוף, that is clothed in the blood of a human being, giving life to the body,

as it is written, “For the *nefesh* of the flesh (i.e., the *nefesh* that וכדכתיב: “כי נפש הבשר בדם היא”, sustains physical and corporeal life) is in the blood.”²⁹

From [this *nefesh*] stems all the evil characteristics, deriving וממנה באות כל המדות רעות, מארבע יסודות רעים שבה, from the four evil elements within it.

Just as the four physical elements of Fire, Air, Water, and Earth are the foundation of all physical entities, so, too, is this *nefesh* comprised of four corresponding *spiritual* elements. Since they derive from *kelipah* and evil, they themselves are evil, and from them, in turn, one’s evil characteristics come into being.

Namely: anger and pride [emanate] from the element of Fire, דהיינו: כעס וגאווה – מיסוד האש שנגבה למעלה, which rises upward;

Once ignited by anger and pride, a man (like fire) soars aloft. Pride is the state of considering oneself superior to others. Anger, too, is an offshoot of pride. Would a person not be proud, he would not be angered when someone defied his will.

the appetite for pleasures [emanates] from the element of Water, ותאֲוֹת התענוגִים – מיסוד המים, כִּי הַמִּים
for water promotes the growth of all kinds of pleasurable things; מַצְמִיחִים כָּל מִינֵי תַעֲנוּג,

The ability of water to make pleasurable things grow indicates that concealed within it is the element of pleasure. Thus, the appetite for pleasure derives from the element of Water.

frivolity and scoffing, boasting and idle talk [emanate] from the והוללות וליצנות והתפארות ודברים בטלים –
element of Air: like air, they lack substance;

and sloth and melancholy [emanate] from the element of Earth. ועצלות ועצבות – מיסוד העפר.

Earth is characterized by heaviness. A man encumbered by sloth and melancholy likewise senses a heaviness of the limbs.

From this soul stems also the good traits inherent in every Jew's וגם מדות טובות שבטבע כל ישראל בתולדותם,
character, such as compassion and benevolence. כמו רחמנות וגמילות חסדים – באות ממנה.

But since this is a *nefesh* of *kelipah* and evil, how do good characteristics come from it? This matter is now addressed.

For in the [case of the] Jew, this soul of *kelipah* is derived from כִּי בְיִשְׂרָאֵל נֶפֶשׁ זוֹ דְקְלִיפָה, הִיא מְקַלֶּפֶת נוֹגֶה,
the *kelipah* called “*nogah*,” which also contains good; and the שֵׁשׁ בָּהּ גַּם כֵּן טוֹב,

[This *kelipah*] is from the esoteric “Tree of Knowledge [which is והיא מסוד "עץ הדעת טוב ורע":
comprised] of good and evil.”³⁰

The souls of the nations of the world, however, emanating from מה שאין בן נפשות אומות העולם, הן משאר
the other, unclean *kelipot*, which contain no good whatsoever, קליפות טמאות, שאין בהן טוב כלל,

as is written in *Etz Chaim*, Portal 49, ch. 3, that all the good that כמו שכתוב בעץ חיים שער מ"ט פרק ג'. וכל טיבו
the nations do is done out of selfish motives. דעבדין האומות לגרמיהו עבדין,

Since their *nefesh* emanates from *kelipot* which contain no good, it follows that any good done by them is for selfish motives.

So the Gemara³¹ comments on the verse, “The kindness of the וכדאיתא בגמרא על פסוק: "וחסד לאומים
nations is sin”³²—that all the charity and kindness done by the חטאת" –שכל צדקה וחסד שאומות העולם עושין,
nations of the world is only for their self-glorification.... אינן אלא להתייחר בו:

When a Jew acts in a benevolent manner, he is motivated mainly out of concern for the welfare of his fellow. The proof of this is that were his fellow not to need his help, this would give him greater pleasure than the gratification derived from his act of kindness.

Concerning the nations of the world, however, this is not so. Their motivation is not the welfare of their fellow; rather, it stems from a self-serving motive—the desire for self-glorification, a feeling of gratification, and the like.

It should be noted that among the nations of the world, there are also to be found those whose souls are derived from *kelipat nogah*.³³ Called “the pious ones of the nations of the world,” these righteous individuals are benevolent not out of selfish motives but out of a genuine concern for their fellow.

Four Elements

Tzaddik, Rasha & Beinoni

Tanya - Lekutei Amarim: Chapter 1

Kabbalah & Chassidism

Tanya

FOOTNOTES

1. *Niddah* 30b.
2. *Avot* 2:13.
3. The apparent contradiction between the two statements is resolved in ch. 13. See also chs. 14, 29, and 34.
4. *Berachot* 7a.
5. *Zohar* II, 117b.
6. This is an alternative interpretation of the words *ורע לו*, which may be rendered literally as “evil [belongs] to him”; i.e, he is master of the evil nature in him.
7. 61b.
8. See beginning of ch. 9, and ch. 13.
9. *Berachot* 18b.
10. *Bava Batra* 16a.
11. *Niddah* 16b.
12. The question is answered in ch. 14 and ch. 27.
13. Cf. *Shabbat* 30b.
14. See *Bava Metzia* 86a.
15. The Rebbe notes that although the *Gemara* in *Kiddushin* 49b indicates only that the penitent sinner is considered a *tzaddik*, it is explicitly stated in *Or Zarua*, sec. 112, that he is considered a *tzaddik gamur*.
16. 20a.
17. 12a.
18. 39b.
19. *Sanhedrin* 99a.
20. *Numbers* 15:31.
21. See below, end of ch. 25.
22. *Otiot d’Rabbi Akiva*; comp. *Bamidbar Rabbah* 14:12.
23. See *Rambam*, *Hilchot Teshuvah* 3:1; *Rashi* on *Rosh Hashanah* 16b.
24. *Psalms* 109:22. See ch. 13, fn. 9, for the note by the Rebbe on the interpretation of this verse.
25. Cf. *Yoma* 38b.

26. Proverbs 10:25.

27. Isaiah 57:16.

28. The Rebbe notes: The addition of the words, “These are two *nefashot*,” makes it clear that the two souls possessed by every Jew are not necessarily of the soul-level of *neshamah*, the third highest of the five soul-levels (viz., *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshamah*, *chayah* and *yechidah*), for this soul-level is not necessarily found in every Jew and certainly not in his animal soul. Rather, this refers to the essential soul-level of *nefesh* possessed by every Jew.

29. Leviticus 17:11.

30. See Zohar I, 12b.

31. Bava Batra 10b.

32. Proverbs 14:34.

33. See *Siddur Im Dach. Shaar Chag Hamatzot* 287c; *Likkutei Biurim* (by Rabbi Hillel of Paritch) 47b.

By Rabbi Schneur Zalman of Liadi, elucidated by Rabbi Yosef Wineberg

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